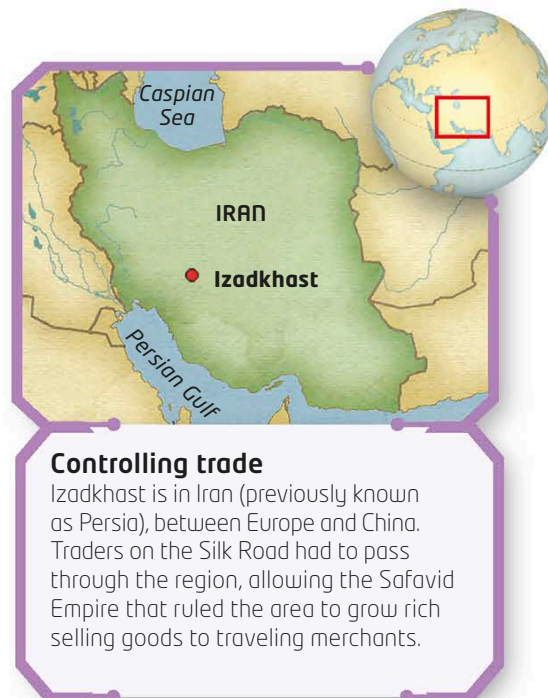


THE SILK ROAD

The 16th-century caravansary (inn) of Izadkhaist sits alongside an ancient trading route winding through the hot, dusty Iranian desert. It was one of many outposts constructed to protect merchants traveling between Asia and Europe. Dotted along the road, caravansaries offered travelers a secure roof for the night, as well as a place for people to exchange goods, skills, customs, and ideas.

Imposing Izadkhaist

The arched gateway was the only way in or out of the caravansary and would have been locked at night to keep the guests safe. The courtyard was a place for trade and socializing, while the niches around the edge provided merchants and their servants with a private space to rest. This caravansary was part of a group of buildings, including a castle.



Controlling trade

Izadkhaist is in Iran (previously known as Persia), between Europe and China. Traders on the Silk Road had to pass through the region, allowing the Safavid Empire that ruled the area to grow rich selling goods to traveling merchants.

